

Canadian Government





About the Course

Students learn about the electoral process, the different aspects of parliamentary government, the Canadian legal system, and the concept of citizenship. They will spend the final term learning about the structure of our local and provincial authorities.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Canadian Government: Grade 7 1 time/week 25 min	Who Runs This Country, Anyway?

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 1 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12		Canadian Government: Grade 7		Plutarch: Grades 6-8 Current Events: Grades 5-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Citizenship: Grade 7 (Canada)

- ☐ Make sure your student sets up a Citizenship Notebook. They will need a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and 5 Tabbed Dividers. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the document in Quick Links.
- ☐ As desired, plan for a read aloud time. Suggestions are provided in the Community Read Aloud Quick Link, but local favorites are highly recommended whenever possible.
- ☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Canadian Government: Grade 7



Who Runs This Country, Anyway?



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

[Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.](#)



Canadian Government: Grade 7

How To Teach



Prepare

Plutarch: Teachers will find it helpful to preread the entire Life first, and then preread the day's passage before each lesson. Mark any passages that should be omitted due to content. (In Anne White's Plutarch Project books, the recommended source for this course, objectionable content has already been omitted.)

Current Events: Preview the news source for suitability.

Most other citizenship topics don't require additional prep.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources, show students how to scan the headlines to get an overview first and then choose a story to read.

For Plutarch or other books: Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story as relevant. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves* and *Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, *Book of Centuries*, and/or *Commonplace book*.



Narrate

Have the students narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions to help students discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Have students record important ideas in their Citizenship Notebooks.

Canadian Government: Grade 7



Term 1		
WEEK 1	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 1	
WEEK 2	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 2	
WEEK 3	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 3	
WEEK 4	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 4	
WEEK 5	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 5	
WEEK 6	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 6	
WEEK 7	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 7	
WEEK 8	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 8	
WEEK 9	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 9	
WEEK 10	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 11	
WEEK 12	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 12	

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)

Term 2		
WEEK 1	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 13	
WEEK 2	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 14	
WEEK 3	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 15	
WEEK 4	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 16	
WEEK 5	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 17	
WEEK 6	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 18	
WEEK 7	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 19	
WEEK 8	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 20	
WEEK 9	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 21	
WEEK 10	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 22	
WEEK 11	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12	25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 24	



Term 3

WEEK 1

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 25

Introduction to Three Levels of Government

→ INTRO

This term, you will learn more about the three levels of government for your own area. This will require independent online research, so be sure to consult with your parent or teacher.

→ REFLECT

Before looking anything up, can you name the three levels of government? Do you remember the titles of the heads of each level, and do you know the names of the individuals who fill these roles in your local area?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Levels of Government (Video)

→ READ

∞ Article Link: Levels of Government

→ NOTEBOOK

Divide a blank page into three columns, and label each with the name of each level of government. Using the links below, enter in as much information as you can regarding the structure and responsibilities of each.

→ EXPLORE

Test your knowledge with the following activities. If you run out of time today, you can test your knowledge during the next lesson.

∞ Link: Activity: Levels of Government

∞ Link: Around Town Game: Levels of Government

WEEK 2

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 26

Federal Government

→ INTRO

Canada is divided into electoral districts, each one represented by a Member of Parliament (MP). These districts are also called ridings or constituencies. Because these areas are determined by population rather than area, some can be geographically very large while others are smaller.

Today, you are going to do some research about your local federal electoral district. By using the resources below, and through additional research with help from your parent or teacher, see if you can answer the following questions:

How many electoral districts are there in Canada?

What is the name of your local electoral district?

Can you find a map of it?

Who is your MP?

What party do they belong to?

Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?

What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?

Can you find out more information about your MP from their own website?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Who are parliamentarians?

∞ Link: Home Page for the 2025 Federal Election

→ EXPLORE

∞ Link: Activity: Parliament and Elections

WEEK 3

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 27

WEEK 4

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 28

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about the federal government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or written.

WEEK 5

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 29

Provincial Government

→ INTRO

Each province and territory has a legislative assembly, forming the provincial level of government. Each province and territory is divided into electoral districts with a representative to the legislative assembly from each district. The boundaries of your provincial electoral district may differ from the federal one. The provincial representative have different titles in different provinces/territories (e.g. Member of Provincial Parliament (MPP) in Ontario, Members of the National Assembly (MNA) in Quebec, and Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLA) in most other places). The leader of the party with the most seats becomes the premier.

Each province also has a Lieutenant Governor who, like the Governor General, is the representative of the King of Canada for each province and territory.

Today, you are going to do some research about your local provincial electoral district. By using the resources below, and through additional research with help from your parent or teacher, see if you can answer the following questions:

Who is the premier of your province/territory and what is their political party?

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

What is the name of your local provincial electoral district?
Can you find a map of it?
Who is your representative, and what title do they have in your province/territory?
What party do they belong to?
When was the most recent election?
Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?
What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?
Can you find out more information about your representative from their own website?
Who is your Lieutenant Governor and how long have they served in this role?

→ VIEW

Find the Elections website for your home province or territory (use search terms "election" and name of province/territory)

WEEK 6

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 30

→ READ & NARRATE

Find a current events article about your provincial or territorial government. Narrate your chosen article either orally or written.

WEEK 7

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 31

Local Government

→ INTRO

Today, you will look at local government. Local governments are a paradox, because we most often forget that they exist, while they often have the most direct impact on our daily lives.

The head of the municipal government is usually called a mayor, but may have a different title in some places. Your municipality might be the same as your city, or, for smaller towns and rural areas, the municipality might be made up of several communities or a wider area. With the help of a parent or teacher look up the website for your municipality and try to answer the following questions:

What is the name of your municipality?

Can you find a map of it?

Who is the mayor (or other title) of your municipality?

What other representatives make up your local government and what are their titles?

When was the most recent election?

Who were the other candidates in the most recent election?

What percentage of the vote did each candidate receive?

Can you find out more information about your mayor from their own website?

WEEK 8

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 32

WEEK 9

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 33

WEEK 10

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 34

WEEK 11

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 35

WEEK 12

25m Canadian Government: Grade 7 - Lesson 36